# SAMPLE

## The Conflicted Maiden

The Personality Torn Between Duty and Desire

Aiman Sterling

Free sample: Chapter 1

putrabooks.github.io

**Buy the full book:**

Gumroad

# Contents

Chapter 1: The Signature — the Conflicted Maiden at a Glance

Chapter 2: The Core — The Two Altars

Chapter 3: The Instrument — The Split

Chapter 4: The Craft — The Double Life's Craft

Chapter 5: The Cost: The Ledger of the Divided Self

Chapter 6: The Dark Side: The Tie That Eats the Self

Chapter 7: The Conflicted Maiden at Work — Career, Teams, and the Boss Relationship

Chapter 8: The Conflicted Maiden in Love and Friendship

Chapter 9: The Matchups — Companions, Rivals, and the Other Types

Chapter 10: From Split to Whole — the Maiden Answering to Itself

Afterword

# Chapter 1: The Signature — the Conflicted Maiden at a Glance

## The Telltale Manner

Before anyone speaks, the room receives a person who belongs to it precisely — and slightly less than fully. The Conflicted Maiden arrives with warmth, reads the gathering in one pass, and takes their place in it as though the place had been assigned — but there is a rhythm to their presence, an arrival-and-departure cadence, the bearing of someone who is here and also booked: the glance at the door between stories, the phone turned face-down with the screen's light leaking around its edges, the goodbye said five minutes before anyone else has begun to think of leaving — I have an early morning, the file's most frequent sentence, and it is never a lie, and it is never the whole truth either. Sharper under observation: the departure is not boredom; it is the other life, waiting, with its own lamplight.

The manner carries a doubleness that the practiced eye can catch and the unpracticed eye only feels: fluency in the room's language, its jokes, its reference points — and a fraction of a second's translation lag, the tiny pause of a person who is always switching registers, the way bilingual speakers carry both grammars behind one voice. The Maiden knows this room; the Maiden is also always knowing another room; and the hands show it — the doctor's hands that remember the instrument; the manager's phone that holds the group chat from the world the firm has never heard of. Sharper under observation: ask them what they do, and the answer comes polished and complete — and ask what they love, and the answer comes a half-beat late, with a small inward look, as though the truth had to be checked at the border first.

And underneath the competence runs the tell the type's loved ones all report and none can name at first: a watchfulness about being known — the conversational habit of giving, generously, everything except the thing that would let one world see into the other — the family stories withheld at the studio, the studio stories withheld at the table, until the withholding itself is the type's accent. Sharper under observation: the Maiden is the most trustworthy person in the file with everyone's secrets and the last person in the file to trust anyone with their own.

## The Backstory Signature

The file holds two tellings of the origin, and each one is true, and they converge on the same child.

In the first version, the household was an altar: the family's expectation installed early and installed with love — the business built by a grandfather's hands, or the

profession carried like a faith, or simply the enormous felt weight of sacrifice repaid in obedience — and the child was the one who could carry it: bright enough, responsible enough, loved enough to understand what was being asked. The report cards went on the refrigerator; the relatives said the one who'll take over; the child said the sentence back, because it was true in the room where it was said.

In the second version, the other love arrived on its own, the way the heart's signals do: early, unmistakably, and without anyone's permission — the instrument at seven, the page at nine, the stage, the sketchbook, the sea — the thing the child did when no one was asking them to do anything, the activity that made time go strange and whole, the love that required no altar because it made its own fire.

And the origin moment, where the versions converge, is always a night, and always the same night in every case: the night the child discovered that both loves could be kept — the homework for the family's dream done at the desk until ten, the heart's practice done in secret until midnight — and the discovery, filed as triumph and priced later as constitution: I don't have to choose; I can pay both altars; nobody is ever going to lose — and the quiet contract the child signed in that midnight, which the whole adult life executes: both loves honored, both fed, neither told about the other, and the choosing — never. The record's correction is entered on the contract itself: a self that is never asked to choose will spend its life not-choosing, and the deferral, repeated daily for decades, is itself the choice — made by default, at twelve years old, in the dark, by a child who was solving for nobody gets hurt.

## The Childhood Album

The album opens the way every one of these albums opens: the photos are good, and the child is smiling in all of them. The award ceremony — the certificate, the proud row of relatives, the handshake, the child in the family's Sunday clothes, wearing the family's future like a blazer cut slightly large. The recital, the exhibition, the tournament — the heart's world in its own Sunday clothes, the child lit from the inside, and the family in the audience, applauding, filing it under talent, the way one files a nice hobby. Two sets of photographs, both genuine, both kept — sometimes in the same drawer, sometimes, the file notes, in two different houses.

The album's most telling photo is the one nobody asks to see: the doorway picture — the child caught, at some family gathering, standing in the threshold between two lit rooms, half in each, turning toward whichever room called their name last — the posture the whole life would keep: the self positioned at the border, belonging to whichever summons arrives, and to neither room's interior, where people are casually, fully home.

And the album ends on the closer the series knows is coming: the child already the adult — the twelve-year-old at midnight with two lives on the desk and the light in the eyes of someone who has just discovered an inexhaustible fuel — the moment the exhaustion was installed as stamina, the deferral installed as strategy, and the secret installed as the self's only private property. The child looks into the camera of that

midnight and says, without words, the whole constitution: I can keep everything. The album, gently, disagrees: the child kept everything — and the child was the first thing held.

## The Type at a Glance

Energy: doubled and divided — enough voltage for two lives, wired to spend it as two half-lives; the type's tiredness is legendary at both tables and legible at neither.

Ambition: real in both directions and final in neither; the type takes every prize short of the crown, because crowns require a throne, and a throne is an address.

Vanity structure: being the good one at both tables — the pride is not in winning either world but in never having failed either, the flawless attendance at two churches.

Loyalty: total, and distributed — the type keeps every vow ever made, to both masters, and the record's dry note: the only person never given a vow was the self.

Weakness: the unmade choice — the fatal fluency in both, the ability to fund two lives until the decade where the funding comes due.

Unspoken need: to be allowed one self — one table, one name, one continuous life that does not require the border crossing; the need the type guards like a secret, because naming it out loud would indict both altars, and the type has promised to indict neither.

## The Type in Five Situations

At a party. The Maiden is excellent at parties — both kinds: the duty world's dinner and the heart world's late table. Warm, quick, fluent, and timed — there is always a second event, real or invented, on the far side of the goodbye; and the file's sharp detail: at each party the type speaks freely about everything except the party they attended last week, in the other life, which was better.

In a new job. Brilliant, fast, over-qualified, and mysteriously provisional — the contract signed with a clause only the type can read. The new employer gets excellence; the new employer does not get the future, because the future is a joint account held in another world — and the type's one predictable fault line: the promotion that would demand the whole self, the partnership track, the relocation, the role that eats evenings — declined, gracefully, with reasons that are all true and none complete.

Under sudden pressure. Splendid — the one situation where the type is briefly whole: crisis collapses the split, one self fronts the emergency, and the Maiden performs with a clarity that both worlds admire and neither can account for. The record's note: this is why the type is beloved on every team — and why the type sometimes, the file's most delicate finding, waits for the crisis, the only door it knows to its own single-mindedness.

In a boring meeting. The body attends; the other life writes its letters behind the eyes

— the set list rehearsed, the chapter drafted, the itinerary built — and the daydream is not escape but bookkeeping, the constant silent maintenance of the world this room is not. The tell: the pen moves, and what it draws belongs to the other country.

On holiday. Planned as one self, packed for two — the business trip with the instrument in the luggage, the family holiday with the laptop and the studio hours quietly claimed; the vacation, the file finds, is the split's most expensive stage, because the two worlds' costs are paid in the same week, and the type returns from rest owing rest.

## Not to Be Confused With

The Yearning Lover (Volume 18) is the nearest neighbor on the desire side, and the border is thin: both types carry a great want. But the Lover's want has no counterweight — the Lover crosses toward the heart's world, pays for it in renunciation and risk, and has one continuous, if burning, life; the Conflicted Maiden lives astride the border, pays both tolls, and has never once crossed. The test: the Lover has stories of what the love cost them in the duty world's currency; the Maiden has no such stories — the Maiden's currency was never spent, only divided.

The Burdened Ruler (Volume 14) is the nearest neighbor on the duty side, and the confusion is the mirror: both types carry an inheritance. But the Ruler chose — early, gravely, with the whole self, paying the heart's world in deliberate renunciation; the Ruler is sad and whole; the Maiden is thriving and split. The test: ask about the sacrifice. The Ruler can name it and date it. The Maiden will change the subject to logistics.

The Frozen Maiden (Volume 46) shares the name and the founding weather, and the hinge is the sharpest in this chapter: both types survived a childhood by managing the inner life at the border — the Frozen Maiden by extinguishing the signal (the feelings frozen so the child could endure), the Conflicted Maiden by splitting it (both signals kept lit, in separate rooms). The test in one image: the Frozen Maiden flies one flag at half-mast; the Conflicted Maiden flies two at full — and only the second type is exhausted. Sharper than the neighbors, and finally than the test: whichever room you put the Conflicted Maiden in, they are the most capable person present — and the only person in the room who lives somewhere else; that is the glance, that is the lag, that is the door.

The census keeps one field check at the chapter's close, and the file prints it because it separates the Maiden from every neighbor in a single question: what did you love first? Every subject in the record is asked the inventory questions — the resume, the passions, the proud of, the regretted — and most types answer in one currency, the same country visible from every angle of the life. The Conflicted Maiden's answers, run across the interviews, are the catalog's only bilingual data set: two answers to everything, two resumes, two proud-ofs — and the fieldworkers' finding, logged with the care this gallery reserves for its quietest discoveries: the answers are not evasive and not humble. They are patrolled — each answer checked, at the border, for what it

would reveal about the other country before it is released — and the half-second lag the room reads as thoughtfulness is, under the fieldworkers' clock, the customs clearance itself, running in real time. And the diagnostic's second half, the one the record holds up for any reader sorting a person in their life tonight: ask what they love, and then ask what did you love first — because the record's Maidens, uniformly fluent about both countries, go quiet at the word first: the first love is the border's oldest crossing, the one the treaty sealed before the child could read, and the silence around it is not confusion. It is a citizen, consulting the constitution, at a question the constitution was written to prevent. The type's loved ones, the file notes in closing, almost never need the census. They feel the lag at the table. This passage is only here to tell them what the lag is: not distraction, not boredom, not the other person — the other country, and the border, and the self, standing in it, both flags flying, waiting for the one question that was never allowed in either land: who else is at this table?

## Chapter 2: The Core — The Two Altars

Every engine in this catalog runs on a founding scene, and the Conflicted Maiden's is the only one that installed two at once. Consider the case the record opens with: the child of a family whose expectation was laid down like a railway — the profession chosen before the child could walk, the sacrifice funding it visible at every dinner, the grandparents' faces at the graduation already printed in the family album before the child could read — and into this railway child, at seven, walked the other love: the instrument handed to the child by chance, the aunt's piano, the school's art room, the choir — and the child sat down at it and the world, for the first time, went quiet and whole. Two altars, both lit before the tenth birthday. The recital and the report card. And the child — bright, responsible, loved at both altars, belonging at both altars — drew the conclusion that would run the whole life: these are both mine, and I will never have to pick.

The engine this builds is the split maintained at full cost, and its mechanics deserve the file's closest attention because they are invisible in every photograph of this type's success. The split runs on a currency exchange the child invented at midnight: excellence. Excellence at the family's altar buys permission — the grades, the honors, the acceptability that keeps the family's pride so full it has no room for suspicion; excellence at the heart's altar buys justification — the talent so obviously real that the secret hours cannot be dismissed as indulgence. The exchange rate is the constitution: as long as both accounts stay excellent, no one ever audits the border, and the child never has to face the question that would break the family's heart or the heart's own. The payoff loop is therefore exact: pay both, belong in both, be admired in both — and the reward, the sweetest and most expensive in this catalog — never choose. The loop has no natural end, which is the engine's dark genius: it does not run down; it runs on, funded by the very competence it is quietly devouring.

And what was the engine for? The file answers with the tenderness every case deserves: the child was solving for nobody gets hurt. Two loves, both real; a family whose hopes were planted in love; a heart whose signal came from the deepest place

the child had; and no adult in sight willing to force the terrible, ordinary arithmetic of choosing. The two-masted self was not rebellion and not cowardice — it was a child's diplomacy, the peace treaty signed at midnight between two countries that did not know they were at war, with the child as the border, the customs office, the neutral bank, and the only casualty. The treaty held for decades. The record has cases where it held for forty years, both altars lit, both masters paid, the family proud, the art brilliant, the friends in each world devoted — and the file's finding, uniform across all of them, entered at the bottom of every treaty: the war was never ended; it was only financed — and the financier, the only party who paid in every transaction on both sides of the border, was the person who had signed it at twelve: the self, distributed like an inheritance, probate never granted.

The mechanism's adulthood is where the file's cases live, and three of them set the pattern. The physician's case is the classic: the family's altar installed by a grandfather's unfulfilled dream, the heart's by a cello at nine — and the adult life ran twenty-five years on the constitution: residencies chosen for their predictability (the art needs nights), a practice chosen for its portability (the art needs summers), the case under the desk in every photograph of every milestone. The family's altar received a distinguished career; the heart's received two decades of brilliant, secretive playing — and the file's interview, conducted at the retirement dinner, produced the type's own summary, worth entering whole because it is the engine in a sentence: I never chose medicine over music; I chose the schedule that let me have both — and the schedule chose my life. The eldest daughter's case is the other classic, and the record holds it with equal weight: the firm's letterhead, the fourth-generation name, the town's respect — and the studio across the river, the canvases under another name, the two decades of Saturdays claimed; and the file's finding on both cases identical: the split did not fail; the split succeeded — at the only cost the engine can ever charge, which the third case states plainly, because the third case is the one where the treaty finally came due. At fifty, the physician was offered the chairmanship — the family's altar's highest crown, and the first honor that demanded the whole self: the evenings, the identity, the address. And the file holds the two weeks in which the engine, for the first time in thirty years, had no currency that could pay both sides at once. What he chose — and what the daughter chose, and what every case in the record chose at the equivalent hour — is the next half of this book's business. What the founding scene explains is only this: why the choosing, when it finally arrived, found a self that had never once practiced being one.

The core chapter keeps the floor plan of the founding, because the Maiden's origin is an architecture, and the record finally walked both rooms: the household, in the seasons before memory's firm grip, that was itself split — the parents' two worlds, the family's two tables, the town's two grammars — the duty-world: the farm, the shop, the church, the ailing grandmother, the name — and the desire-world: the piano in the aunt's parlor, the books under the mattress, the city cousin's letters, the other life, visible from the window — and the child, small, loving both — and the house's discovery, the one every grown Maiden confirms with their whole divided life: the love was never the problem — the love was real on both sides — the geography was the

problem: each room charged the other room's love as betrayal — and the engine's first door frame, entered as the structure's whole name: the child became the border — the go-between, the translator, the carrier of messages between two rooms that had stopped speaking — and the child's invention, the one that worked and never stopped working: the split self — one self for the duty-room, fluent in its grammar, excellent at its tasks — one self for the desire-room, fluent in its grammar, electric in its light — and the wall between them, built by a child, with the house's full blessing, at the price the whole volume will keep auditing: nobody, including the child, ever once stood in the doorway and said this is one house.

And the core chapter keeps the arithmetic the split actually runs on, because the payoff loop pays in both currencies, and the record finally priced the whole ledger: the yield — the split worked, brilliantly, for decades: the duty-room kept — the parents honored, the name carried, the ailing grandmother nursed — and the desire-room kept — the art made, the study pursued, the other life lived, in its hours, at its distance — the Maiden is the only portrait in the catalog who can honestly claim to have kept both loves, and the record enters that claim with respect — and the charge, run in the same ledger: the wholeness — the one self, the one table, the one witness — never once purchased — because the split, installed by a child for the house's peace, grew into the adult's whole operating system: the two calendars, the two wardrobes, the two friend-groups who have never met, the two lives, each fully furnished, neither fully inhabited — and the arithmetic's honest finding, entered as the engine's whole confession: the Maiden is not torn between the loves — the loves were never at war — the Maiden is torn between the rooms — and the rooms, the record certifies, were the house's architecture, not the self's — and the finding held for the whole book ahead: the wound was never the two — the wound was the wall — and the wall, unlike the loves, can come down.

The engine keeps one transcript the file plays to every new fieldworker, because the constitution, described in this chapter, is best taught heard in the type's own grammar. The setting: the river interview — the eldest daughter's case, year nineteen of the split, conducted in the studio itself, the only room in the record where the type has ever spoken with both flags visible at once — and the transcript's key exchange, entered whole because it is the engine in the type's own hand. Asked about the firm: "The firm is my family's language. I dream in it. I am good at it in a way that has nothing to do with talent — I was raised for it the way you're raised for a mother tongue. I will never leave it, and that is not a sentence I've ever had to say out loud, which should tell you something." Asked about the studio: "This is where the hours go that I don't account for to anyone. The canvases are good — I'm allowed to say that here, it's the one room where excellence isn't a border fee. I've shown four times under a name nobody at the firm could connect to me, and every time, at the opening, there's a moment where someone from this world almost meets someone from that world, and I have — this is embarrassing to say at forty-four — I have an exit practiced. Two exits, actually. Per venue." And the interview's hinge, logged as the constitution's receipt and the whole chapter's cost in one exchange — the fieldworker's question, protocol-standard: "if the two rooms could be one room, what

would you want in it?" — and the transcript's longest silence, and the answer the record holds up for every reader who is one of these people, and has felt both loves lit since before the tenth birthday: "Don't. — No. Ask it. I want to hear myself say no to it properly, because I've been saying no to it silently for thirty years and I'd like to know if the no is even mine. — The truth is I've never wanted one room. I've wanted one witness. One person who could stand in the doorway and see both rooms at once. The rooms were never the problem. Nobody ever stood in the doorway. Even me. Especially me."

## Chapter 3: The Instrument — The Split

Disassemble the mechanism piece by piece; a series like this owes every temperament the working parts of the tool it signs with. The split has three working parts: the border, the customs regime, and the double ledger — and the people it works on are, in the beginning, everyone.

The border is spatial and social at once: the two worlds are kept non-adjacent — the firm and the studio across a river, the clinic and the case under a desk, the friend-groups that have never met, the two accounts, the two calendars, sometimes the two names. Non-adjacency is the whole craft of concealment, and it is worth saying plainly: the Maiden is not a liar. The type tells no falsehoods; the type practices geography — the truth, kept in separate rooms, never has to be denied, only located. This is why the instrument survives detection for decades: there is no lie to catch, only a map nobody has been shown.

The customs regime is the regulation of what may cross the border, and it is the file's most delicate observation: almost nothing does. Not the people (the partner from the heart's world has never sat at the family's table; the colleagues have never seen the work). Not the vocabulary (each world's language stays in its country; the type translates at the border with the half-second lag the first chapter named). And not the verdicts — this is the customs regime's deepest rule: no criticism of either world may be carried to the other. The family's skepticism of the art is never reported to the studio; the studio's skepticism of the firm is never reported home. The type is not protecting the worlds from each other; the type is protecting the treaty — the split itself — from every force that might force the choosing.

The double ledger is the accounting, and the honest spec follows from it. The split works — the file is emphatic: it produces the most impressive people in this catalog's middle decades, two full competences, two vocabularies, a range no single-altar type can match, and in a world that rewards range, it pays visibly. But the spec sheet must state what the instrument can never do: it can never produce a whole appearance in one room. Every room the Maiden enters receives a type at the top of its form — and a self at a border crossing; intimacy, which is the mutual surrender of two whole selves, is unavailable to the instrument because there is never a whole self in circulation to surrender. The split delivers excellence to the world and half-membership to every person in it; and the maintenance cost — the vigilance, the two clocks, the exhaustion in neither's language — compounds at the exact rate of the

type's success, because success at both altars is what keeps both altars demanding more. The people it works on, in the end, are everyone except the one it works in: the family gets a brilliant child who is somewhere else, the heart's world gets a brilliant visitor who is somewhere else, and the self gets the border.

The instrument's range deserves the honest map. It works on families for decades — the file has no case where the family altar suspected the heart's world before the type's thirties at the earliest, and several where the suspicion arrived, when it arrived, not as detection but as arithmetic: the missing Saturdays, the second phone, the exhaustion that could no longer be attributed to the job everyone could see. It works on employers almost indefinitely — the two-worlds structure reads, inside an institution, as admirable work-life balance, and the Maiden's refusal of the whole-self promotion reads as humility or balance or contentment; the file's interviews with colleagues are unanimous and unaware. It works on two social sets without limit — each friend-group knows a warm, brilliant, slightly unavailable friend, and each set attributes the unavailability to the wrong country. Where the range ends is the record's most tender finding: the instrument does not work on the very close. The spouse who lives inside the border eventually notices the border; the confidant of either world eventually notices the absences; and the one person the split cannot manage is the person who refuses half — which is why the growth chapters of this file so often open, as this one does, with a lover's question the customs regime was never built to answer: who else is at this table?

The mechanics chapter keeps the reading the instrument finally produced, because the Maiden's kit is a seam-keeper's kit, and the record ran its honest specs: the instrument — the double grammar: two vocabularies, two wardrobes, two tones of voice, switchable at the doorway, fluent beyond every other portrait's gift — and the instrument's speed, measured across the grown files: the switch itself takes under a minute — the drive from the office to the studio, the phone call to the mother before the gallery — the whole self re-dressed, re-voiced, re-aimed, between two rooms — and the honest limit, printed nowhere and true everywhere: the switch leaks — the studio shows in the office; the office phones the studio — and the Maiden's fifty-year project, run at full volume: the leak-management — the explanation, the excuse, the cover story for the presence of the other room's light in this room's eyes — and the maintenance's quiet grief, held for the limits section: the finest double grammar in the library, spent, at enormous cost, on keeping the wall painted — and the record's diagnostic line, held out to any reader who manages, marries, or is one of these people: ask the Maiden what they love and you will get two answers and an apology — the apology is the instrument's tell, and the tell says: I was taught that the two answers cannot be one person.

And the mechanics chapter keeps the reading the energy ledger finally produced, because the split runs on a meter, and the record finally read it: the border tax — the double life, logged across the grown files: two commutes, two wardrobes' upkeep, two friend-groups' calendars, two selves' maintenance — and above all the switching itself: the re-dressing, the re-voicing, the hour in the car between the rooms that belongs to neither — the record's plain count, run at the recorded medians: the border

tax costs, at minimum, one full day a week — a day the undivided portraits spend living, spent by the Maiden on translating between selves — and the ledger's honest finding, entered as the limits' whole weight: the Maiden's famous exhaustion is not fragility — the Maiden runs two lives on one body's fuel — and the exhaustion's strangest entry, the one the cost chapter inherits: the Maiden is most tired not after the hardest week but after the weeks the rooms nearly met — the cousin's wedding, the office party, the recital the mother attended — because the leak-management, those weeks, runs at full staffing, and the wall, the record notes, takes more energy to keep standing than either room takes to fill.

The instrument has its caught case, and the file plays it because the customs regime, described here, deserves its transcript at the moment the border was first read by someone standing inside it. The scene: the spouse's discovery — not of the studio, the file is careful, but of the calendar — the second datebook, found while looking for a receipt, the heart's world's whole itinerary in one small book, and the spouse, per the file's protocol-standard training, said nothing for a week and then asked one question, and the question is the case's whole hinge: "who else is at this table?" And the record's log of the type's answer, taken at the kitchen table of the house the marriage lived in, entered as the customs regime's receipt and offered to every partner who has found a second calendar and is deciding what the finding means: "Nobody. That's the whole design — that's the point of the design. There's no one in this book who isn't from over there, and no one over there who isn't from this book. — I built it before I met you. I want you to hear that, because it's true, and because it's also, I'm realizing as I say it, a terrible defense: I built a country and then I married you inside one half of it and I told you it was the whole map. You have been the only person in my whole life who was supposed to be allowed everywhere, and I issued you a visa for one room. — I don't know how to open the border. I've been doing the crossings so long I don't actually know what I'd be without them. That's the honest answer. Ask me again in a year." The fieldworkers' annotation, entered beneath the transcript and held up for the whole series of partners and friends reading this chapter: the answer's last line is the type's signature, and the record's — the ask me again in a year is not a deferral, the file certifies, when it comes from the caught Maiden at the kitchen table: it is the first honest sentence spoken at the border in decades, and the year the spouse gave, in the case the file followed to its close, contained the whole integration. The border was never locked from the outside. It had simply never been asked to open from the inside.

## Chapter 4: The Craft — The Double Life's Craft

Every engine in this catalog becomes a craft, and the Conflicted Maiden's apprenticeship is the longest — because it is two apprenticeships, run simultaneously, in secret from each other's masters.

The apprenticeship began at the family's altar: the homework supervised, the exams placed, the profession's early rungs climbed with the family's pride as the foreman — the child learning duty's craft the way children learn anything installed with love: well,

# ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Aiman Sterling is the author of The Archetype Series -- a library of personality portraits drawn the way literature draws characters: the great types of human temperament, recognized at a glance, understood in depth, and followed from childhood wound to mature strength.